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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Local Government Service Delivery Appraisal Through Citizen Satisfaction Index System	
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Program or Project has component (if no, proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation	
Municipality/City:	Cuartero
Province:	Capiz
Region:	VI

(5) Classification Research: Development:	(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent
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☒ Basic ☐ Pilot Testing ☐ Applied ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	☒ Collaborative Research (within the center) ☒ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☒ Collaborative Research (external agency)
(7) Sector/Commodity Governance and Policy	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Strategic Planning and Public Policy

(9A) Abstract

This descriptive survey study used the Citizen Satisfaction Index System to appraise the local government service delivery satisfaction and the need for action across seven (7) service areas. There is an equal participation of male and female respondents. Seventy-five respondents, both male, and female, were considered. The multi-stage probability sampling was used to ensure that every citizen, 18 years old and above, male or female, who has lived at least six months in the LGU is given an equal chance to be selected as a participant in the study with no preference for any particular socio-demographic characteristic, political/ideological orientation or religious belief. Results revealed high satisfaction and a low need for action regarding support to education, governance and response, and environmental management. This implies that These service areas exceeded the expectations of the citizens. As cited by the citizens, positive aspects of the services have to be sustained. There is a need to evaluate if other resource commitments can be refocused. Service areas such as health, social welfare, public works and infrastructure, and economic and investment promotion resulted in continued emphasis. This means that there is a need to sustain positive aspects of services as cited by the citizens. Moreover, fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved.

(9B) Keywords

Citizen Satisfaction Index System, need for action, satisfaction, service areas,

(10) Introduction

The Citizen Satisfaction Index System (CSIS) is a set of data tools designed to collect and generate relevant citizens' feedback on the local government's service delivery performance and the citizens' general satisfaction. DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2012-113 promulgated the implementation of the CSIS.

The CSIS is a client/citizen perception-based performance assessment that measures the respondent's satisfaction with public services. To contextualize satisfaction data, the analysis involves several steps covering the concepts of awareness, availment, satisfaction, and need for action (CSIS Manual, 2021). The DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2021-003 pertains to the Policies and General Guidelines for the Implementation of the Citizen Satisfaction Index System. The CSIS will cover identified local government units as recipients of the Seal of Good Local Governance. The Municipality of Cuartero is the only municipality in the Province of Capiz qualified for the criteria.

The concerned parties in implementing CSIS are the Bureau of Local Government Supervision (BLGS), the DILG Regional Office, and the Local Resource Institute (LRI). In the case of the Municipality of Cuartero, Capiz State University served as the LRI. The LRI, as an academic institution, provides training, learning, and extension services in the communities. Data generated may serve as baseline data to guide the Local Government Unit to improve its

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delivery of essential services to the citizens.

This study aimed to appraise the local government service delivery of basic services as to satisfaction and need for action.

(11) Methodology

Research Design

The study used a descriptive survey design to appraise the satisfaction and need for action across seven (7) service areas of the local government unit.

Duration and Location of the Study

This study was conducted from September 2021 to July 2022 in all 22 barangays of the Municipality of Cuartero, Capiz. Sample barangays were generated using sampling with probability proportional to size.

Respondents of the Study

There is an equal participation of male and female respondents in the study. Seventy-five respondents, both male and female, were considered. The multi-stage probability sampling was used to ensure that every citizen, 18 years old and above, male or female, who has lived at least six months in the LGU is given an equal chance to be selected as a participant in the study with no preference for any particular socio-demographic characteristic, political/ideological orientation or religious belief.

Data Gathering Procedure

The researchers sought permission from the municipal mayor in coordination with the Department of the Interior and Local Government. Courtesy visits and ocular inspections in the barangays were done. The respondents signed an informed consent form to ensure ethical standards. The questionnaire on the Citizen Satisfaction Index System of the DILG was utilized. The spot map, Kish grid, and call sheets were also used to guide the field interviewers during data collection.

Data Analysis

Gathered data were analyzed using descriptive statistics such as frequency counts and percentages.

(12) Results and Discussions

Citizen's Satisfaction Rating

Table 1 presents the comparative results in all service areas regarding satisfaction. Of the 150 respondents, 130 (87.25%) were satisfied with the health services offered by the municipality, while 19 (12.75%) were not. The overall service area assessment to support the education of the local government showed that the number of respondents who are satisfied (125 or 91.24%) is higher than those who are not satisfied (12 or 8.76%). Of the 150 respondents, 131 (89.73%) are satisfied with the social welfare service program, while 15 (10.27%) are not satisfied. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating. Of the 150 respondents, 135 (93.10%) are satisfied with the services on governance and response, while 10 (6.90%) are not satisfied. Five respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating. The overall service assessment rating revealed that more (119 or 80.41%) respondents were satisfied than those who believed otherwise (29 or 19.59%) regarding public works and infrastructure services. Two respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them.

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The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high rating. The respondents are satisfied (115, 84.56%) with the local government's efforts in terms of environmental management. Sixteen respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked. The overall satisfaction percentage score is high. One hundred seven (75.89%) of the respondents are satisfied with the local government's economic and investment promotion programs and services, while 34 (24.11%) are not satisfied. There were nine respondents who needed to be made aware of any program, which is why the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating from the people of Cuartero.

Governance and response got the highest satisfaction rating (93.10%), while the lowest is on economic and investment promotion (75.89%). The study by Gabinete et al. (2022) cited the citizens viewed health service as the most prominent (Yecla and Ortega, 2020), but this is in contrast to another study that reported otherwise (Torreno, 2017). It must be noted that most of the projects in the Philippines came with a meager budget. With a limited budget comes fragmented programs that will hardly reach the more significant number of rural farmers in our study sites; hence, the local government needs more awareness of agricultural facilities and farming-related programs. According to Gabinete et al., using the CSIS survey tool in Lambunao, Iloilo, the Philippines, on seven local government unit service areas revealed a high awareness rating (81%), especially on health services.

Table 1. Comparative results in all service areas in terms of satisfaction.

Service Area	Satisfied		Not Satisfied	
	f	%	f	%
Health	130	87.25	19	12.75
Support to Education	125	91.24	12	8.76
Social Welfare	131	89.73	15	10.27
Governance and Response	135	93.10	10	6.90
Public Works and Infrastructure	119	80.41	29	19.59
Environmental Management	115	84.56	35	15.44
Economic and Investment Promotion	107	75.89	43	24.11

Citizen's Need for Action Rating

Table 2 presents the comparative results in all service areas in terms of need for action. Ninety-two (61.74%) agreed on the need for action on the health services/programs while 57 (38.26%) do not feel the need for appropriate action. The overall service area assessment as to support to education of the local government showed that most of the respondents (79 or 57.66%) believed that there is no need for action in this area than those who felt otherwise (58 or 42.34%). In terms of the need for action on social welfare service program, 78 (53.42%) felt that there is a need to do so while 68 (46.58%) believed otherwise. A high need for action is suggested by the need for action rating. On governance and response, 72 (49.66%) agreed

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that there is a need for action while 73 (50.34%) believed otherwise. The overall need for action score still suggests a high need for action to be taken.

Table 2. Comparative results in all service areas in terms of need for action.

Service Area	Need for Action		No Need for Action	
	f	%	f	%
Health	92	61.74	57	38.26
Support to Education	79	57.66	58	42.34
Social Welfare	78	53.42	68	46.58
Governance and Response	72	49.66	73	50.34
Public Works and Infrastructure	97	65.54	51	36.46
Environmental Management	99	72.79	*	*
Economic and Investment Promotion	93	65.96	48	34.04

The overall service assessment rating for public works and infrastructure revealed that out of 148 respondents, 97 (65.54%) believed there is a need for action, while 51 (36.46%) thought otherwise. Two respondents were not aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall need for action is high. The respondents believed that a need for action (99, 72.79%) with the local government's efforts in terms of environmental management. There were 16 respondents who were not aware no any program which is why the overall questions were not asked to them. The need for action rating is high. On the local government's economic and investment promotion programs and services data revealed further that 93 (65.96%) of the respondents said that these economic and investment promotion programs or services need appropriate action from the local government. In comparison, 48 (34.04%) felt otherwise. Nine respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them.

Environmental management obtained the highest need for action (72.79%), while governance and response (49.66%) are the least. Poor service delivery may affect the citizens' perception (Susanto and Goodwin 2010). Failure of the government to offer quality services will develop into public distrust, while highly acceptable and well-planned programs and services will raise trust in the government. Ninety-five percent of the citizens clamored for more actions, mainly for public works and infrastructure (Gabinete et al., 2022). Ranking of services according to overall satisfaction is in this order: health services > support to education > social welfare > environmental management > governance and response > economic and investment promotion > public works and infrastructure (Gabinete et al., 2022).

Citizen's Overall Satisfaction and Need for Action

Generally, the majority (127 or 84.67%) of the people in Cuartero are satisfied with the overall services given to them by the local government. Only 23 (15.33%) are unsatisfied (See

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Figure 1). Despite their high trust and satisfaction, 100 (66.67%) of them suggest that the local programs or services offered need appropriate action from the local government to improve these services. 50 (33.33%) of the respondents believed there was no need for proper action (See Figure 2). The percentage score obtained suggests a high satisfaction and need for action ratings from people of the local government. This implies a continued emphasis on sustaining the positive aspects of the services cited by citizens—Fine-tune on specific aspects of service delivery that still be improved. In the case of Gabinete et al. (2022), citizens clamored for more action on the social welfare aspects. The government must therefore identify the constituents' needs and design policies to address these issues in the hope of attaining more responsive social welfare development. In the present study, however, environmental management had the highest need for action.

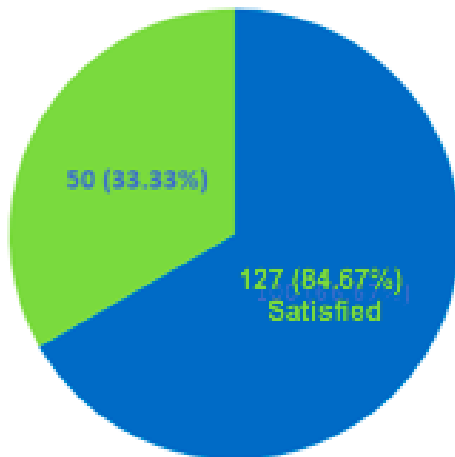


Figure 1. Overall satisfaction rating.

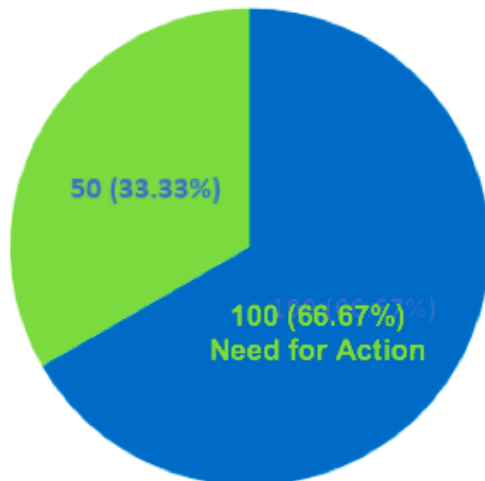


Figure 2. Overall need for action rating.

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Figure 3 presents the overall action grid of all service areas. The following service areas are found to have high satisfaction and low need for action: support to education, governance and response, and environmental management. This implies that These service areas exceeded the expectations of the citizens. As cited by the citizens, positive aspects of the services have to be sustained. There is a need to evaluate if other resource commitments can be refocused.

Service areas such as health, social welfare, public works and infrastructure, and economic and investment promotion resulted in continued emphasis. This means that there is a need to sustain positive aspects of services as cited by the citizens. Moreover, fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved. The respondent's satisfaction may also be due to high expectations of the services. If met, higher expectations may contribute to satisfaction with the services being rated (Gabinete, 2022).

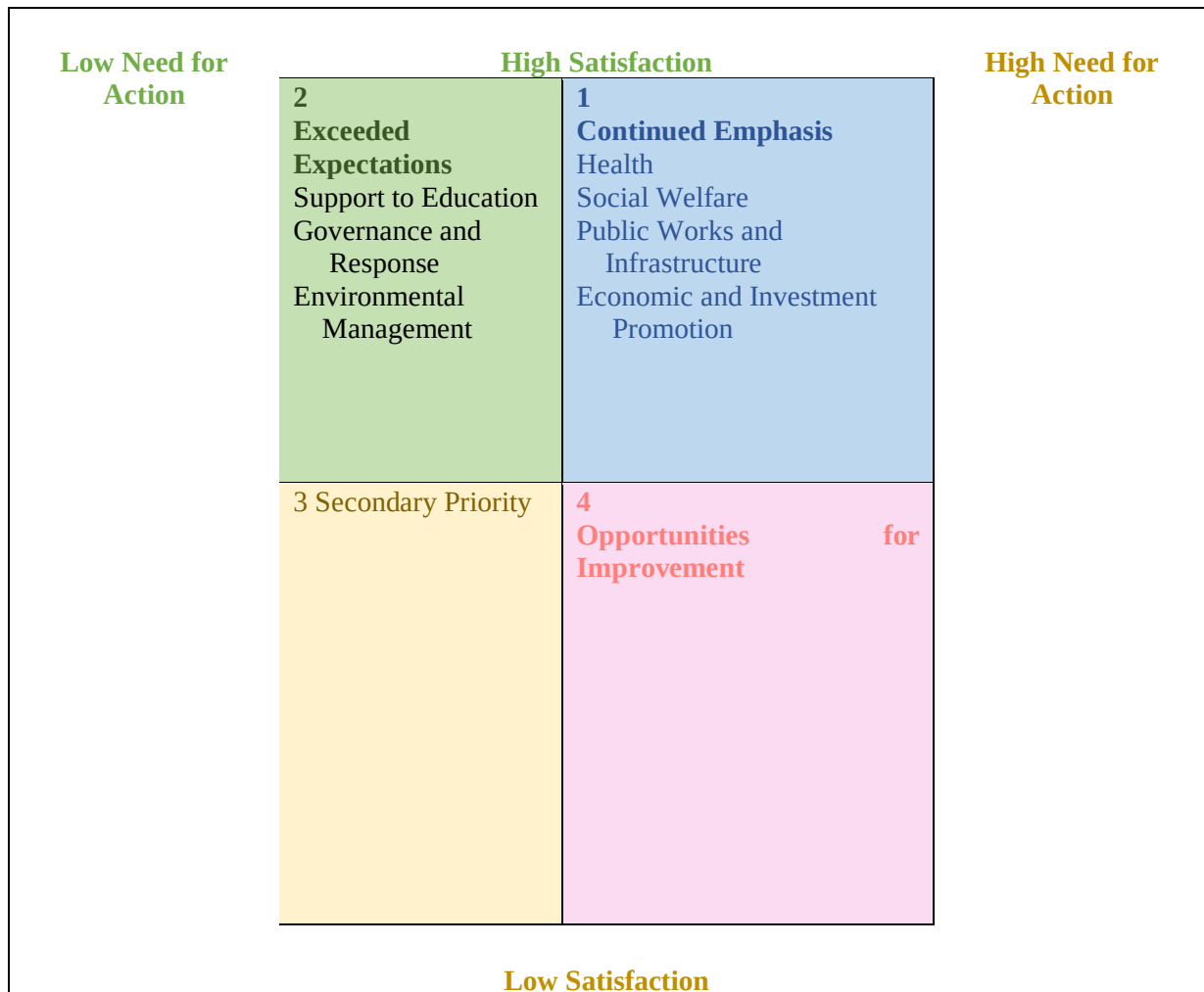


Figure 3. The overall action grid showing the service areas.

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations

Conclusions

Consistent citizens' satisfaction in the various service areas entails that the local

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government unit delivers the goods and services.

With the high satisfaction and need for action, the quality of service delivery may be good, but there is still a need to tune specific aspects further to sustain the current service and/or exceed the citizens' expectations.

Recommendations

Develop effective mechanisms to widely disseminate the services the local government offers in all communication platforms to bring informed choices, especially to citizens residing outside the town proper.

Proper coordination between key persons at the municipal and barangay levels may be observed to ensure the continuous equitable availment of all the services offered by the local government, proper coordination between key persons at the municipal and barangay levels may be observed. Information sharing may bet be kept open. Regular and participatory monitoring at the ground level may be done. Top-down and bottom-up approaches of community engagement can be utilized.

Continuous monitoring, evaluation, and replanning may be done to maintain and/or further improve the performance of the municipality in all service areas. New normal and next normal schemes are deemed necessary.

The exemplary practices of the local government should be maintained. Areas needing improvement may be properly identified for the formulation of solutions which might effectively address the emerging problems.

(14) Output

Focus Group Discussion with the Civil Society Organizations (CSOs)

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted

(17) Acknowledgments

Social Science and Industrial Technology Research and Development Center
Department of the Interior and Local Government Capiz and Region VI
Municipality of Cuartero

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